POW-MIA SCRIPT

LADIES AND GENTLEMEN, PLEASE DIRECT YOUR ATTENTION TO THE CENTER OF THE GATHERING.

AS YOU ENTERED THE AREA, YOU MAY HAVE NOTICED A SPECIAL TABLE, RAISED TO CALL ATTENTION TO ITS PURPOSE AND FILLED WITH SYMBOLISM – IT IS RESERVED TO HONOR OUR MISSING COMRADES IN ARMS.

I WILL EXPLAIN.

THIS TABLE IS SET FOR OUR PRISONERS OF WAR AND THOSE MISSING IN ACTION FROM EACH OF THE ARMED SERVICES.

THE EMPTY PLACES REPRESENT THEY ARE NOT WITH US TODAY BUT THAT THEY ARE WITH US, IN SPIRIT.

THE TABLE IS ROUND – TO SHOW OUR EVERLASTING CONCERN.

THE TABLECLOTH IS WHITE, SYMBOLIZING THE PURITY OF THEIR INTENTIONS TO RESPOND TO THEIR COUNTRY'S CALL TO ARMS.

THE SINGLE RED ROSE REMINDS US OF THE LIVES OF THESE AMERICANS…AND THE LOVED ONES AND FRIENDS WHO KEEP THE FAITH, AWAITING ANSWERS.

THE YELLOW RIBBON SYMBOLIZES OUR CONTINUED UNCERTAINTY, HOPE FOR THEIR RETURN AND DETERMINATION TO ACCOUNT FOR THEM.

A SLICE OF LEMON TO REMIND US OF THEIR BITTER FATE, CAPTURED OR MISSING IN A FOREIGN LAND.

A PINCH OF SALT SYMBOLIZES THE TEARS OF OUR MISSING AND THEIR FAMILIES.

THE LONE CANDLE SYMBOLIZES THE FRAILTY OF A PRISONER ALONE, TRYING TO STAND UP AGAINST HIS OPPRESSORS. REFLECTING OUR HOPE FOR THEIR RETURN.

THE GLASS IS INVERTED. TO SYMBOLIZE THEIR INABILITY TO SHARE A TOAST.

THE CHAIR IS EMPTY – THEY ARE MISSING. (Moment of silence)

AS WE LOOK UPON THIS EMPTY TABLE, DO NOT REMEMBER GHOSTS FROM THE PAST, REMEMBER OUR COMRADES. REMEMBER THOSE WHOM WE DEPENDED ON IN BATTLE. THEY DEPEND ON US TO BRING THEM HOME.

PLEASE HONOR AND REMEMBER THEM.